

KEY

- Volcán Wolf giant tortoise
- Fernandina giant tortoise
- Volcán Alcedo giant tortoise
- Santiago giant tortoise
- Santa Cruz giant tortoise
- San Cristóbal giant tortoise
- Española giant tortoise

ANIMALS IN DANGER

Of the 14 species of Galápagos giant tortoise listed by the IUCN, six are regarded as critically endangered, three as endangered, two as extinct, and the rest as vulnerable. Hunting and habitat destruction have been threats in the past, but now conservation measures are slowly making progress.

Isla Pinta

Isla Marchena

PACIFIC OCEAN

Volcán Wolf giant tortoise

Volcán Wolf, the highest volcano in the Galápagos, on the island of Isabela, is home to a species of giant tortoises that have either domed shells or saddleback shells, like the one shown here.

Santiago giant tortoise

Giant tortoises on Santiago have been hunted extensively in the past, but protection is now helping to restore the species. Their shells are intermediate, between dome-shaped and saddleback-shaped.

Volcán Alcedo giant tortoise

The different habitats on Isabela has meant that different species of giant tortoise have evolved there. Those on the volcano of Alcedo have a black, domed shell.

Isla Pinzón

Fernandina giant tortoise

For more than 100 years, the saddleback-shelled tortoises from the island of Fernandina were thought to be extinct, until a century-old female was discovered in 2019, raising hopes that others have survived too.

Bony shell

Like other tortoises, giant tortoises have a hard, protective shell made from bony plates that are fused to the reptile's backbone and ribs.

Horny beak

Tortoises lack teeth, but instead have a sharp-edged beak that is used to crop vegetation – mostly in the form of grass, shrubs, cactuses, and the occasional fruit.



THE **ESTIMATED**
LIFESPAN OF A
GALÁPAGOS **GIANT**
TORTOISE IS 170 YEARS



Santa Cruz
giant tortoise